

MUHAMMAD SHAHBAZ

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Highly talented Sr. Solution Architect with 16 years of experience designing, securing, and governing national-scale digital infrastructures, sovereign government clouds, and defense ecosystems. Project delivery expert in defining system security context, concept of operations, and baseline security control requirements for multi-level secure networks, in line with applicable cybersecurity policies. Proven track record of performing cybersecurity architecture reviews, identifying gaps,

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sr. Solution Architect

(Confidential)

Sep 2019 – Present | Riyadh

- **Functional Design & Architecture:** Responsible and delivered functional specifications, High-Level Designs (HLD), Low-Level Designs (LLD), Bills of Materials (BOQ), and technical RFP documentation to define system security contexts.
- **Architecture & Design:** Responsible for network system security integrations, upgradation, concept of operations, and baseline and requirements across sovereign government clouds and high-performance networks in compliance with national policies.
- **Solutions Integration & Deployment:** Designed, configured, managed, and troubleshoot complex security solutions across multi-tenant enterprise frameworks, integrating Firewalls, IDS/IPS, Web Application Firewalls (WAF), IAM/PAM, Endpoint Protection (EDR/NDR/XDR), DLP, SIEM/SOAR and automated threat detection agents; determined and documented appropriate security controls for each information system and network.

Delivered Projects: F5(LTM/GTM), PingIdentity, FORTRA (DLP), BeyondTrust (PAM), Symantec (EDR/DLP), Barracuda, SentinelOne (EDR/MDR).

- **Next-Generation Firewalls (NGFW):** Delivered multiple successful projects with expert lifecycle management, deployment, and security baseline orchestration across multi-vendor platforms (PaloAlto-FW, FortiGate-FW, Juniper SRX-FWs).
- **Cybersecurity Reviews & Risk Management:** Delivered regular cybersecurity architectural **GRC** reviews to identify vulnerabilities and structural gaps, developing comprehensive risk management plans and system control deployments aligned with **NCA, SDAIA-PDPL, SAMA, CCC/CCC+, and ISO 27001** standards and frameworks.
- **Functional Documentation:** Designed detailed functional specifications mapping out technical security architectures, integration pathways, and core platform API designs to ensure highly testable, compliant infrastructures.
- **Business Continuity & Availability:** Defined strict availability levels, disaster recovery guidelines, and continuity of operations requirements for critical national data engines, minimizing single points of failure.
- **Emerging Tech Proof-of-Concepts:** Designed and delivered secure multi-level interfaces and systems supporting successful proofs-of-concept (PoC) and pilot projects combining AI/ML workflows with secure enterprise-grade environments.
- **E-Government Scale Operations:** Designed and executed end-to-end infrastructure, data pipelines, and security controls for the **Tawakkalna E-government Platform**, ensuring high availability, load balancing, and secure data for endpoints.
- Designed, implemented, and tested secure interfaces between enterprise systems and physical/embedded infrastructure (e.g., datacenter access control systems, IoT sensors, network appliances), ensuring end-to-end security compliance.
- **Multi-Cloud & Hyperscale Security:** Architect and govern comprehensive cloud-native and hybrid security blueprints (IaaS, PaaS, SaaS) across Microsoft Azure, AWS, and private clouds, ensuring robust protection of mission-critical cloud workloads.

Infrastructure Consultant

GLOBAL HEALTH CARE, WHITES & KUNOOZ

Nov 2017 – Aug 2019 | Riyadh

Working as technical lead for implementation on list of projects including, (Routing & Switching, Security Technologies, Service Provider Technologies, Data Center Technologies).

Worked as Solution Network Design and draft of Proposal and HLD draft of Data Center network and the DR site.

Design and managed a multi-tier, distributed **Splunk Enterprise Security (ES)** infrastructure processing multiple terabytes of data per day across a national-scale sovereign cloud ecosystem.

Endpoint & Data Security Log Ingestion with managed host security, data monitoring, and log baseline configurations for enterprise systems utilizing **TrendMicro Deep Security (EDR/Email Security)** and Fortinet Endpoint Protection (FortiClient).

Day to day operation for **Splunk Indexer** Clusters (with SmartStore storage tiering) and Search Head Clusters to ensure high availability, zero data loss, and optimal search execution speeds for critical defense analytics.

Managed complex data analyzing, event breaking, and source typing via **Splunk Heavy Forwarders**, creating advanced custom Regex rules to normalize unstructured application and endpoint telemetry into Common Information Model (CIM) compliance.

Mapped detection alerts inside **Splunk Enterprise Security** directly to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, building custom high-fidelity correlation searches that reduced false-positive noise by over 30%.

Integrate **Splunk Enterprise Security** with GHC, Whites, Kunooz and NDC multiple Branches (200+), Campus and HQ sites with Optimized LAN and WAN design setup.

Implemented Python and PowerShell automation **frameworks** to integrate infrastructure platforms with **Splunk Enterprise Security** SIEM and **SOAR**, driving zero-touch threat containment through streamlined, automated playbook responses.

Perform assessment of server, Storage, Backup, Database, Network and Application levels.

Responsible for Network/System security policies and adding rules to protect Network/Endpoint.

Sr. System and Network Engineer

AI JABER GROUP

Dec 2014 – Nov 2017 | Riyadh

Drafting High level design document to present and justify the provided solution according to customer's requirement and industry's validated design considerations.

Designed and sized distributed **IBM QRadar** architectures for high-throughput enterprise environments, accurately calculating Event per Second (EPS) and Flows per Minute (FPM) metrics to strategically deployment.

End-to-End Implementation, tuning, installation and deployment of **QRadar** SIEM platforms, configuring custom security profiles, tenant networks, and asset databases to optimize real-time correlation engine performance.

Deployed **IBM QRadar** Complex Log Integration & Custom DSMs for seamless log ingestion pipelines for non-standard telemetry sources by developing custom Device Support Modules (DSMs) using advanced regular expressions (Regex), log extraction, and custom QID mapping.

Streamlined the IBM QRadar onboarding of diverse enterprise log sources, configuring IBM WinCollect agents for Windows event forwarding, Syslog headers for network security infrastructure (Firewalls, IDS/IPS), and REST API integrations for cloud services.

Optimized the Ariel database storage and data-tiering frameworks, defining granular retention buckets and routing configurations to balance immediate investigation availability with long-term compliance mandates.

Deployment & installation of CUCM high availability solution at ALJABER to accommodate Cisco Unity IM & Mail, Unity Connection, and IP phony features.

Deployed the Remote Access VPN using Site-to-Site VPN, Secure Socket Layer, campus and remote sites designing, configuration, and implementation.

Project Engineer

3D Tech Ltd

Aug 2012 – Nov 2014 | Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

ArcSight ESM & Vertica Architecture Design: Designed and architected enterprise-wide Micro Focus ArcSight SIEM topologies, implementing high-performance, distributed Smart Connectors and Logger tiers backed by optimized Vertica database storage solutions.

Delivered **ArcSight** end-to-end deployment, hardening, and configuration of ArcSight Enterprise Security Manager (ESM) clusters; executed comprehensive user acceptance testing (UAT), stress-testing ingestion limits, and validating correlation engine performance under high EPS (Events Per Second) loads.

Orchestrated the seamless data and rule migration from legacy log aggregation systems over to centralized **ArcSight** ESM platforms, ensuring zero data loss, continuous compliance monitoring, and historical event log integrity.

Managed large-scale log normalization frameworks, identity, and cloud telemetry streams into the standard **ArcSight** Common Event Format (CEF) to enable high-fidelity cross-device correlation.

Developed sophisticated correlation rules and session lists within **ArcSight** ESM to detect advanced persistent threats (APTs) and network anomalies while continuously tuning out false positives.

Performance and Monitoring (Solar Winds, PRTG Networks, Packet Analyzer, Cacti).

Proactively ensure the highest levels of systems and infrastructure availability (L2, L3) Circuits.

Network & Security Engineer

JAZZ Telecom Company

Jun 2009 – Aug 2012 | Pakistan

Responsible and deployed enterprise-scale LAN, WAN, and Secure Remote Access (VPN) networks, embedding advanced telemetry and logging hooks to ensure seamless integration with central **SOC** monitoring systems, detection frameworks for real-time security operations visibility.

Configured and managed Access-Layer switches for security and access policies, integrating 802.1X and port-security telemetry into central **SOC** monitoring dashboards.

Configured and managed Distribution-Layer devices with routing protocols, access control, QoS, and redundancies, establishing NetFlow data exports to monitor advanced **SOC** threat hunting.

Configured Cisco ASA firewalls (failovers, policies, traffic inspection), routing centralized logs to **LogManager** for comprehensive **SOC** security analytics.

Deployed and tuned Intrusion Prevention Systems (IPS), mitigating alert fatigue for the **SOC** by streamlining signature alerts within **LogManager**.

Drove regional account growth through strategic field visits focused on managed **SOC** and **LogManager** integration solutions for major prospects.

Collaborated with clients on complex infrastructure design changes, ensuring all implementations seamlessly onboarded onto **SOC** security monitoring platforms.

Excellent hands-on experience with security solutions and technologies, including Web Security solutions.

Implementing and collaborating with other IT professionals, such as network engineers, software developers, and database administrators, to ensure seamless integration of systems

Monitoring servers in the local branch and over the Live IP Configuring and monitoring IIS for dynamics web pages.

EDUCATION

PhD Informatic Engineering

Univeristy of Coimbra

Sep 2025 – Present | Portugal | GPA: 3.92

Master of Computer Science

COMSATS Institute Information Technology

Sep 2014 – Aug 2016 | Pakistan | GPA: 3.96

Bachelor of Computer Science

Mohi-Ud-Din Islamic University

Sep 2000 – Jan 2004 | Pakistan | GPA: 3.90

SKILLS

AI/ML, Python, EDR, NAC, NDR, IAM, PAM, DLP, Email Security, SIEM, SOC, SOAR, Threat Hunting, Cyber Defense.

Linux, Microsoft, OpenSource, Pytorch

Leadership

Problem Solving

Project Management

LANGUAGES

English (Fluent)

Arabic (Professional)

CERTIFICATIONS

CCIE Enterprise Infrastructure - EI (LAB Exam passed) # 69159

Cisco

TOGAF-10 Enterprise Solution Architect | 197307

OpenGroup

Project Management Professional (PMP) Certified | 2915841

PMI

Certified Information System Manager (CISM) By ISACA

ISACA

Certified Information System Auditor (CISA) By ISACA

ISACA

Microsoft Azure Infrastructure Solution Architect by Microsoft | MS0990987017

Microsoft